

6.1 Algebra Review in Ten Lessons

http://math.uakron.edu/%7Edpstory/mpt_home.html

As far as the page goes, this site is pretty simple: 10 PDFs for you to download. What we'll talk about here is the content of some of those.



What is most important (and valuable) about Prof D P Story's course (or "review") on algebra is the depth of understanding of the fundamentals it provides. Consider this, for example, from the first chapter:

"In this lesson, we review some very basic ideas and terminology of the so-called Real Number System. Do not take this first lesson lightly, your knowledge of the real number system and its properties is key to your understanding why certain algebraic manipulations are permissible, and why others are not. (When you are manipulating algebraic quantities, you are, in fact, manipulating numbers.)"

So you'd wonder why you need to know about the number system when learning algebra, and Story explains above—adding not to take it lightly. That should give you an idea about how comprehensive the course is.

Then, consider this snippet from chapter 2, something others would probably just skip, assuming the reader has gathered it from the preceding text:

"*Terminology:* The symbol a^k is called a power of a . We say that a^k has a base of a and that k is the exponent of the power of a ."